



INDIAN STARTUP FUNDING

# How Money Moved Through India's Startup Scene (2015 to 2020)

Funding Trends · Industries · Cities · Investors





## PROBLEM STATEMENT

# What This Analysis Set Out To Do

*This project looks at Indian startup funding data from 2015 to 2020 to understand where investment went: which industries, cities, and funding stages pulled in the most capital, and who the investors behind the money were.*

- 1 How has total funding trended over time?
- 2 Which industries received the most funding, and how has that shifted?
- 3 Which cities are the biggest startup hubs?
- 4 How is funding split across stages, from Seed all the way to Private Equity?
- 5 Who are the top investors, by deal count and by amount?
- 6 What is the average and median deal size, and how does it vary?



## METHODOLOGY

# From Raw Records to Clean Insight

3,044 startup funding records from 2015 to 2020. Raw, real-world data with the usual mess: Indian-format currency strings, inconsistent city names, duplicate funding-stage labels, and malformed dates.



### Python

Cleaned currency formats, standardized 100+ city names, collapsed 55+ stage labels into 17 clean categories



### SQL

Aggregated and ranked funding by year, industry, city, stage, and investor



### Power BI

Built an interactive dashboard across four pages with drill-through and filters



## OVERVIEW

# The Numbers at a Glance

**\$38.14bn**

TOTAL FUNDING

**3,044**

TOTAL DEALS

**\$18.40M**

AVERAGE DEAL SIZE

**\$1.75M**

MEDIAN DEAL SIZE

**2,364**

UNIQUE INVESTORS

**68.1%**

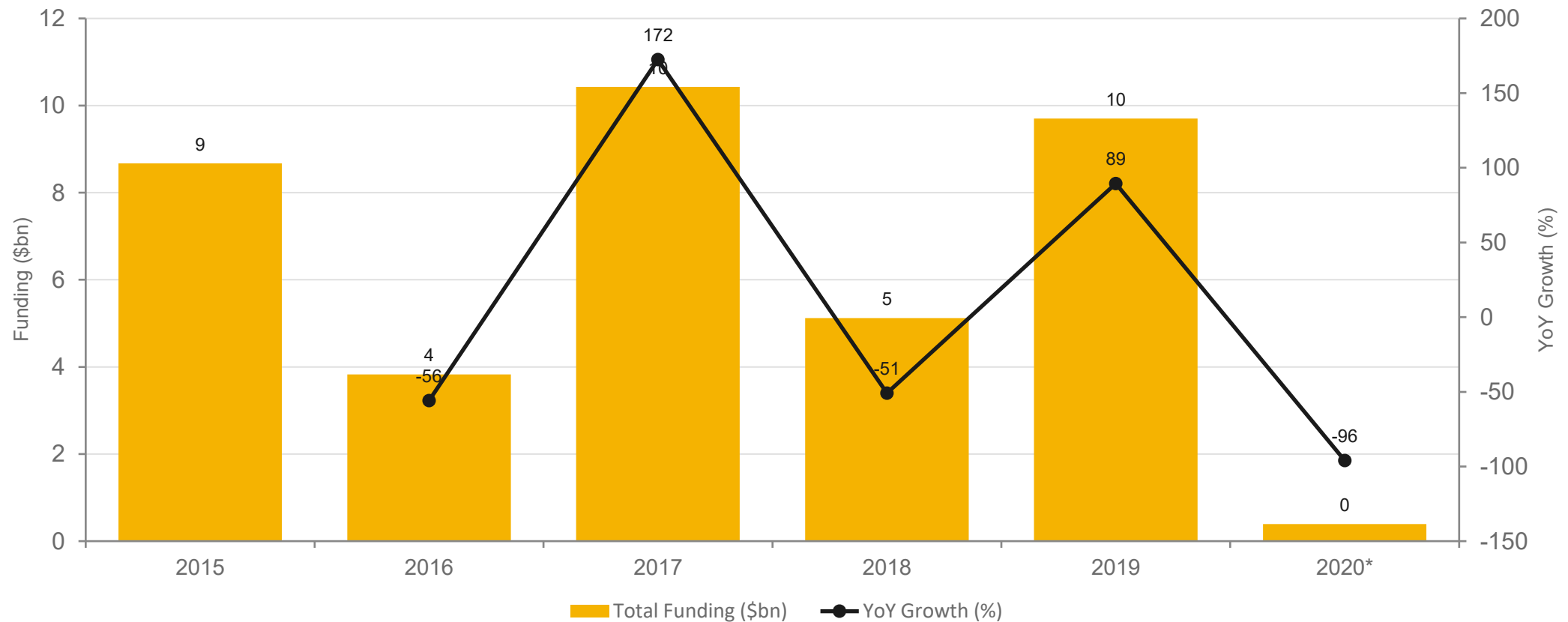
DEALS WITH DISCLOSED AMOUNT

*Notice the gap between the average (\$18.4M) and the median (\$1.75M). It tells you a small number of mega-rounds are pulling the average way above what a typical funding round actually looks like.*



## QUESTION 1

# Funding Trend & Year-over-Year Growth

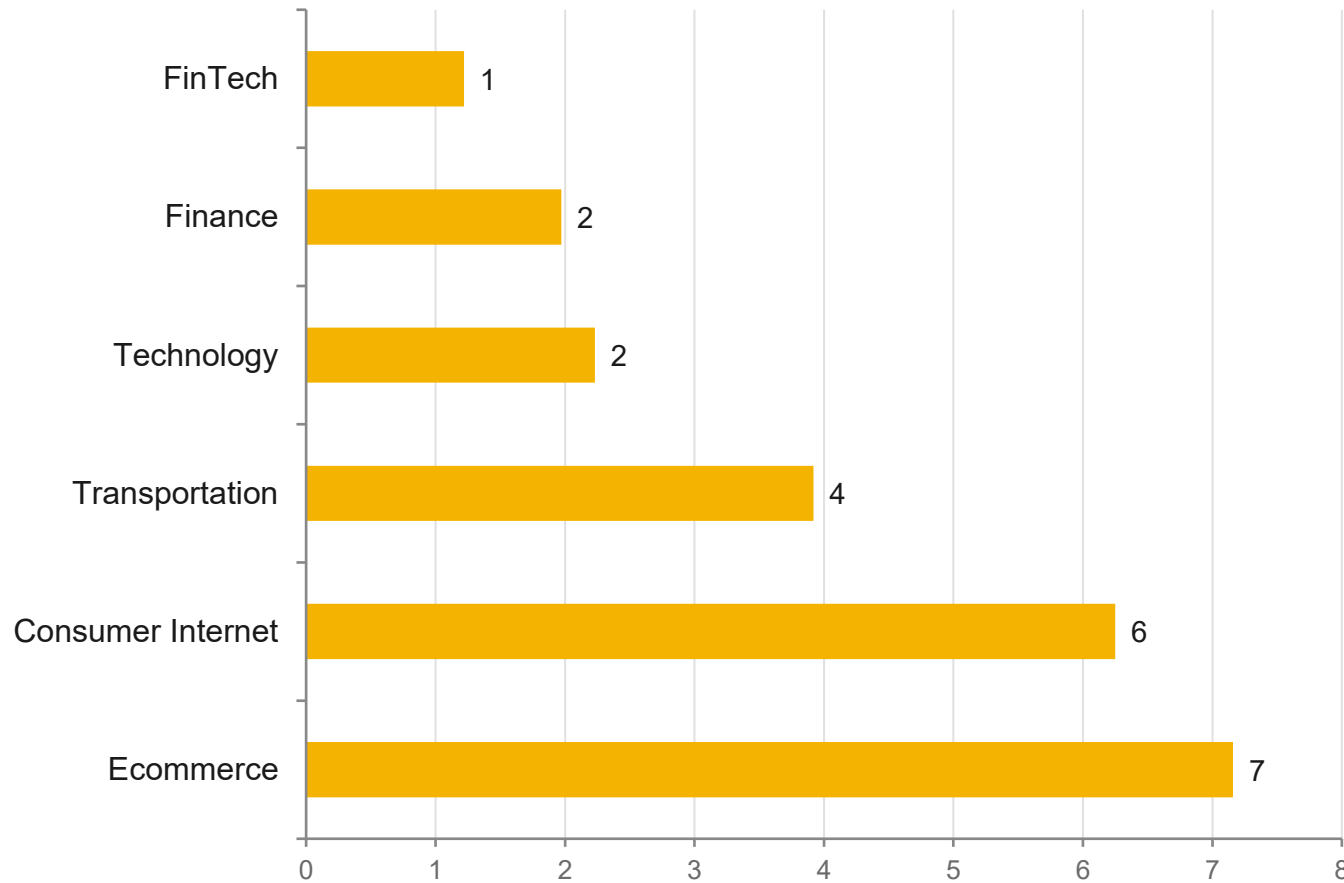


*\*2020 only includes January data, since the dataset ends early in the year. That is why the drop looks so sharp.*



## QUESTION 2

# Industries by Total Funding



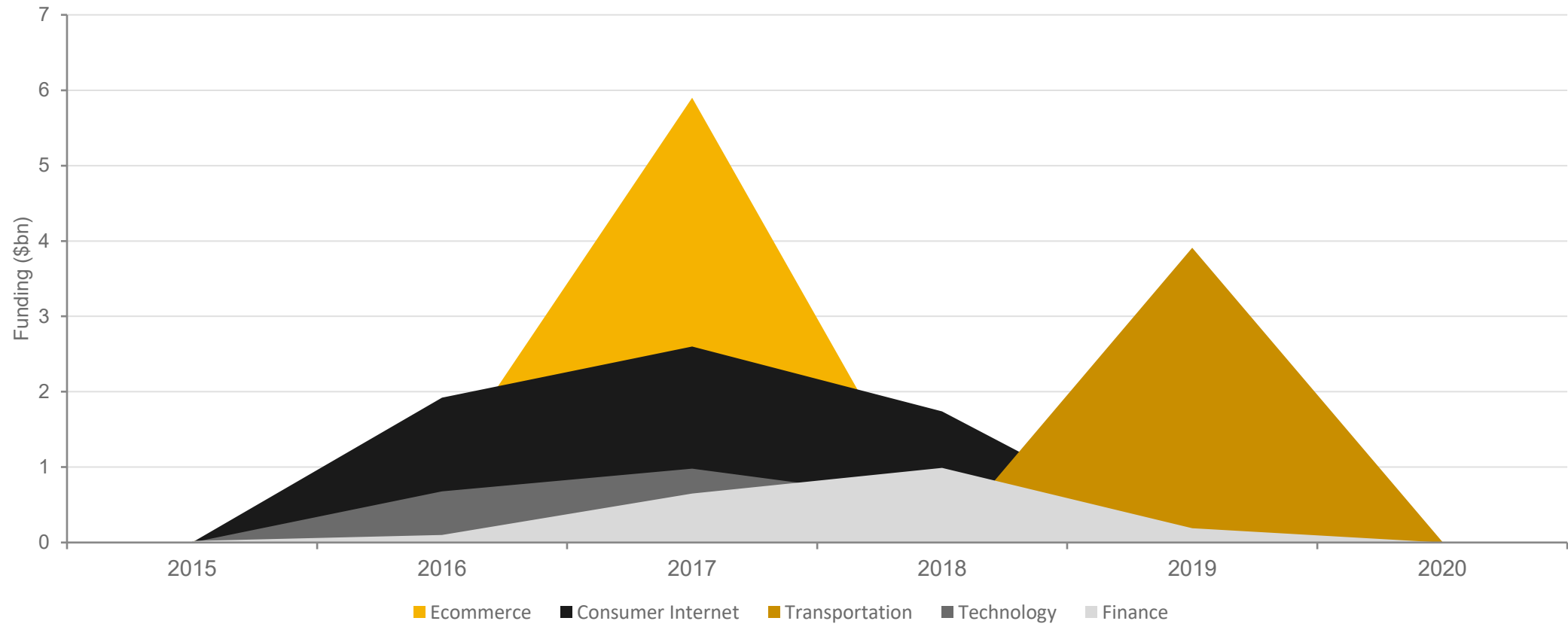
## Ecommerce and Consumer Internet lead

Together, these two industries pull in roughly a third of all disclosed funding. That is more than double what Transportation, the next-largest category, brings in.



## QUESTION 2, CONTINUED

# Industry Funding Over Time

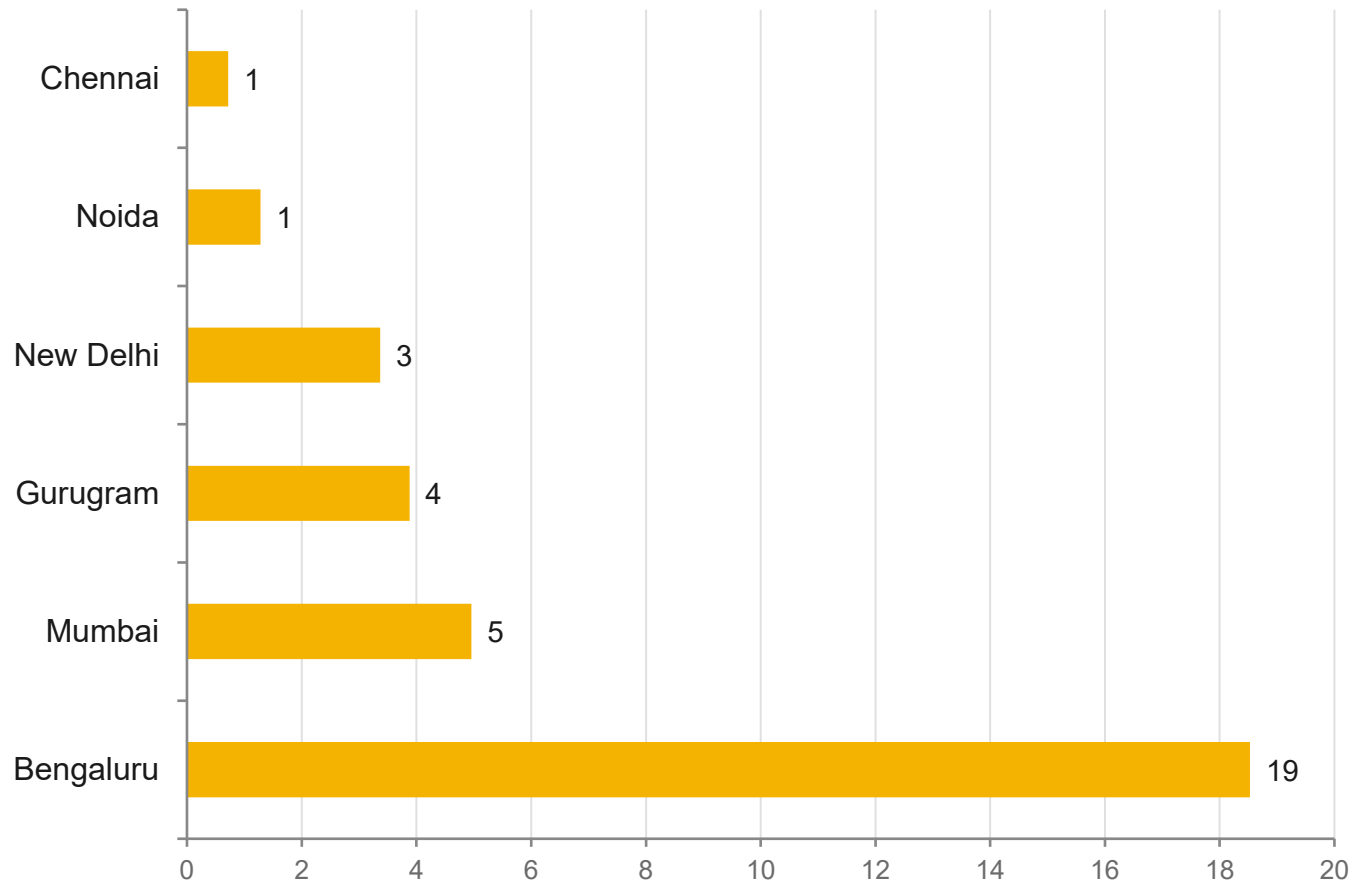


*Ecommerce and Consumer Internet dominated 2016 to 2018, but Transportation's surge in 2019, driven by a handful of large rounds, shows how quickly capital can concentrate in a single sector.*



### QUESTION 3

## The Biggest Startup Hubs



### Bengaluru stands alone

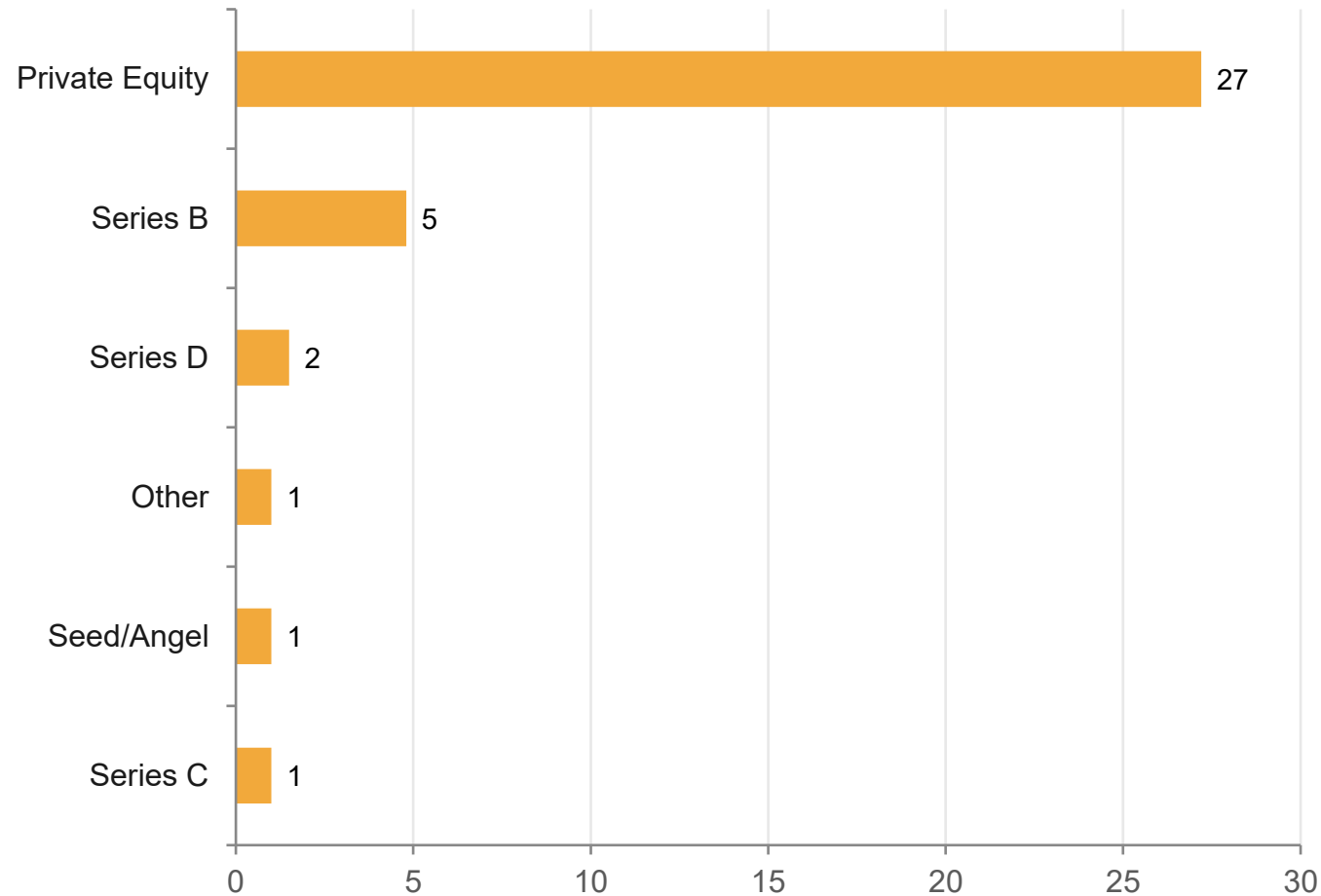
Bengaluru's \$18.5bn is nearly 4x Mumbai, the next largest hub. The top four cities alone capture most of all startup capital, so funding is really concentrated in a handful of metros rather than spread out nationally.





#### QUESTION 4

## Funding by Investment Stage



**71.4%**

OF ALL FUNDING IS PRIVATE EQUITY

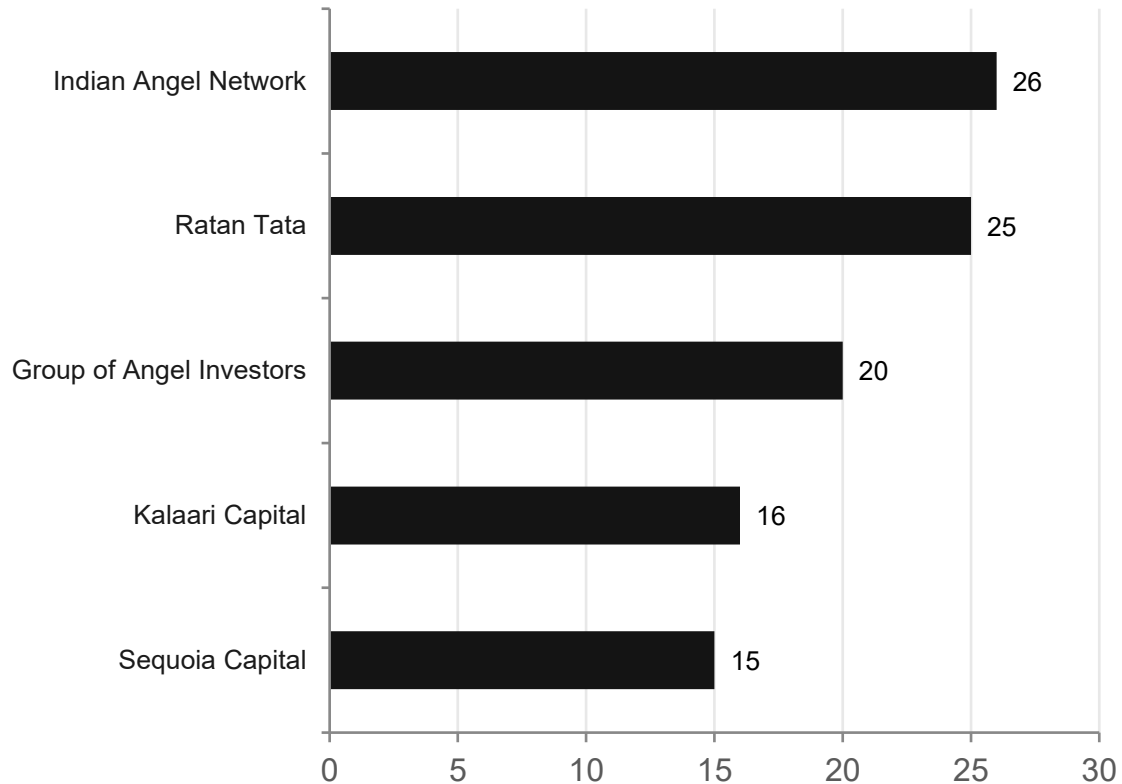
Private Equity rounds make up a small share of total deals but dominate the dollars. A few large, late-stage rounds are doing most of the heavy lifting here.



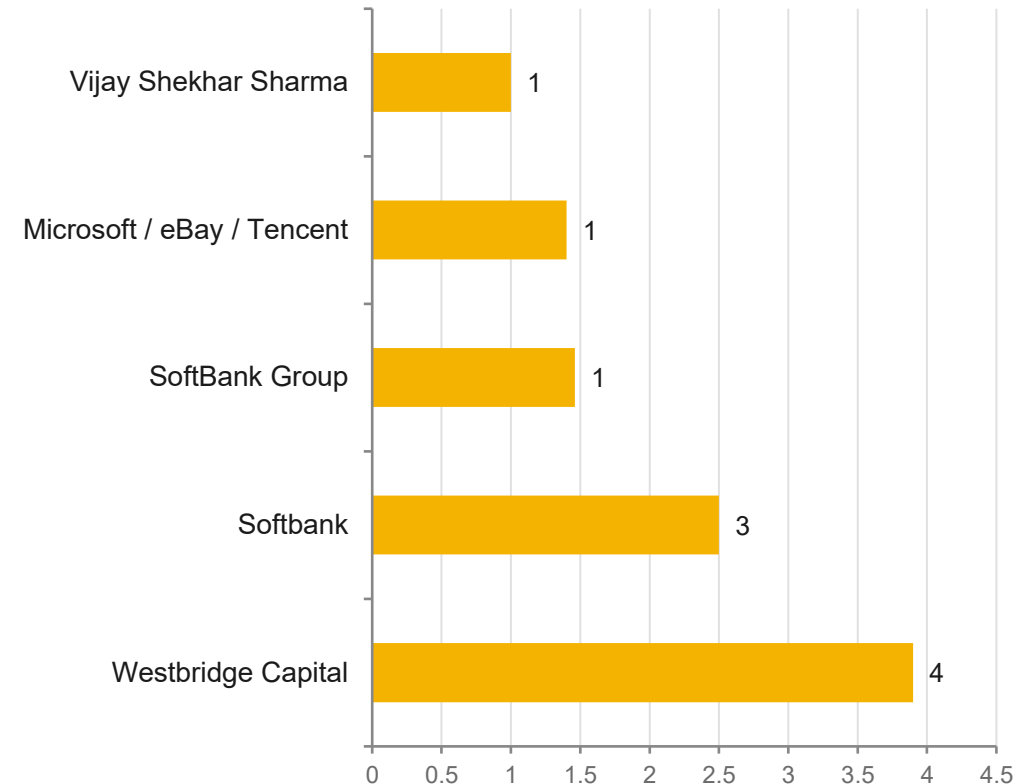
## QUESTION 5

# Who Are the Key Investors?

MOST ACTIVE, BY DEAL COUNT



LARGEST, BY TOTAL AMOUNT (\$BN)

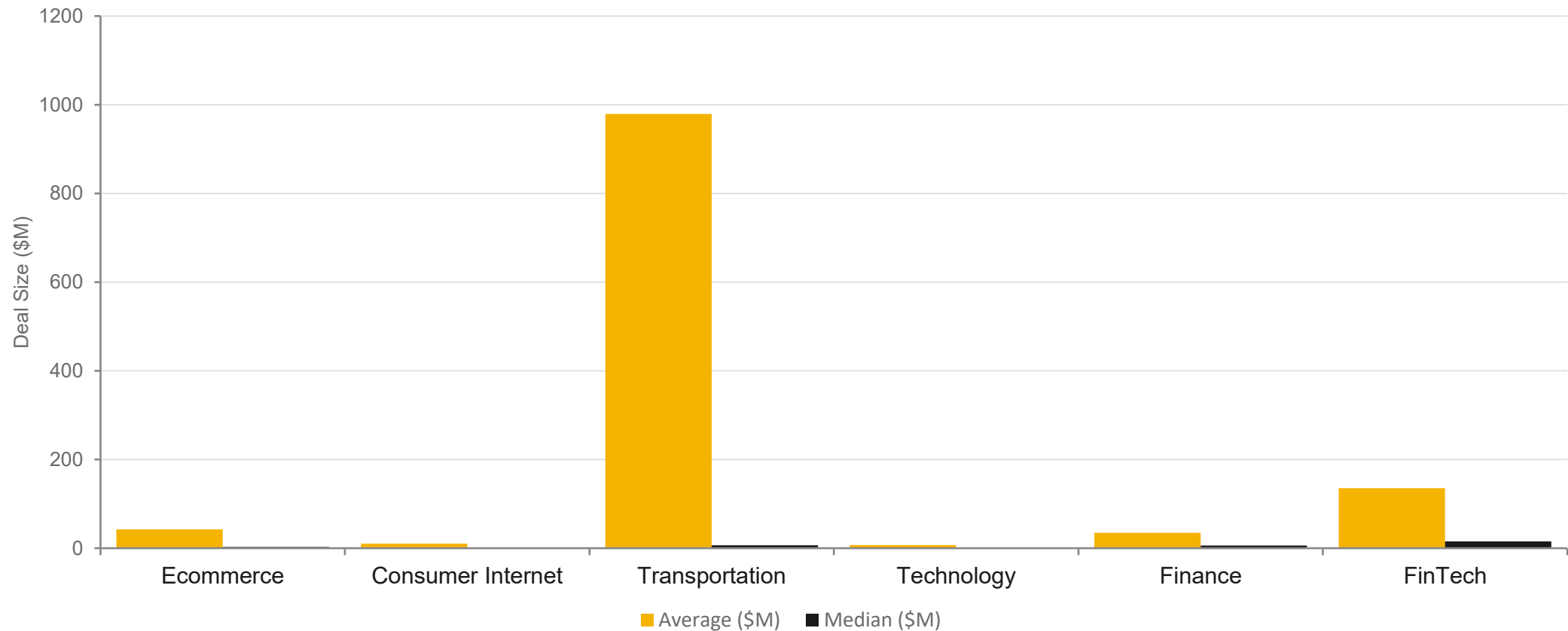


*The two lists barely overlap. The most frequent investors are mostly angel networks writing lots of smaller checks, while the biggest dollar amounts come from a handful of institutional investors writing far fewer, much bigger ones.*



## QUESTION 6

# Average vs. Median Deal Size, by Industry

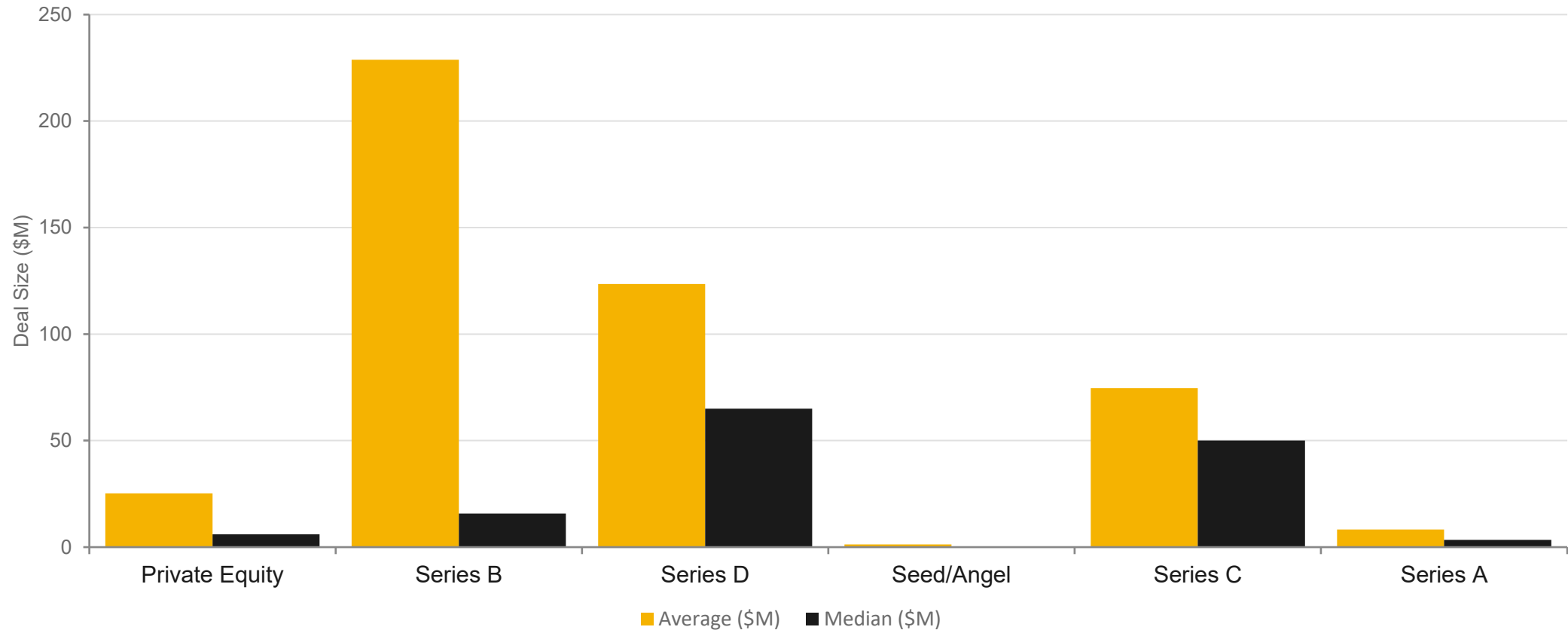


*Transportation shows the widest gap: a \$979M average against just a \$6.5M median. A small number of mega-rounds are skewing the average way above what a typical deal in that sector actually looks like.*



## QUESTION 6, CONTINUED

# Average vs. Median Deal Size, by Stage



Early stages like Seed/Angel and Series A show average and median sitting close together, so deal sizes there are fairly consistent. Later stages spread out more, since fewer, bigger rounds start pulling the average up.



## SUMMARY

# Key Takeaways



### **Funding is concentrated, not spread out**

One city (Bengaluru), one stage (Private Equity), and two industries (Ecommerce and Consumer Internet) soak up a disproportionate share of the total capital.



### **The average deal size is a bit misleading**

The median (\$1.75M) is a much better picture of a typical round. The average (\$18.4M) gets dragged up by a handful of billion-dollar raises.



### **Investors tend to fall into two very different camps**

Angel and network investors show up often, writing lots of smaller checks. Institutional investors show up rarely, but when they do, the checks are much bigger. It is almost never the same players doing both.



## CAVEATS

# Limitations of This Analysis



### Undisclosed amounts

About 32% of records do not have a disclosed funding amount. So the totals here only reflect the disclosed portion, and the true market size is probably larger.



### Partial year coverage

The dataset only runs through January 2020, so that year is not complete. It should not be compared directly against the full years before it.



### Some category judgment calls

The original industry and sub-vertical labels were inconsistent in the raw data, so a few grouping decisions had to be made during cleaning.